

Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Model – Presentation Script

Presenter 1 (Slides 1–4)

Slide 1 – Introduction

Good morning everyone.

Today, we are going to present the **Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Model**, a widely used framework for understanding and managing workplace conflicts.

Before we discuss the five conflict styles, let's understand the conflict we'll use throughout this presentation.

Slide 2 – What is the Thomas-Kilmann Model?

Conflict is a natural part of every workplace because people have different goals, responsibilities, and opinions.

Instead of avoiding conflict, the Thomas-Kilmann Model helps us choose the most appropriate way to handle it depending on the situation.

Slide 3 – How does the TKI Model manage conflicts?

The model is based on two important dimensions:

- **Assertiveness**, which means how strongly a person tries to satisfy their own concerns.
- **Cooperativeness**, which means how much a person considers the concerns of others.

By combining these two dimensions, the model identifies five different conflict management styles.

Slide 4 – Conflict Scenario

Now let's consider a real workplace situation.

ABC Technologies has developed a banking application.

The **Development Team** wants to release the application tomorrow to meet the client's deadline.

However, the **Testing Team** has identified several critical bugs that could affect customer transactions.

Now a conflict arises.

Should the company release the application on time, or delay the release to improve software quality?

Let's see how each conflict management style would solve this same situation.

I now invite **Presenter 2** to explain the **Competing** style.

Presenter 2 – Competing

Thank you.

The **Competing** style focuses on achieving one's own objective without considering the concerns of others.

It has **high assertiveness** and **low cooperativeness**.

This approach is best used during emergencies where quick decisions are necessary.

How does it solve our conflict?

In this case, the **Development Team insists on releasing the application immediately** to meet the client's deadline.

The software is delivered on time, but the critical bugs remain unresolved.

Although the deadline is achieved, customer satisfaction and team relationships may suffer.

Now I invite **Presenter 3** to explain the **Avoiding** style.

Presenter 3 – Avoiding

Thank you.

The **Avoiding** style means postponing or ignoring the conflict instead of addressing it immediately.

It has **low assertiveness** and **low cooperativeness**.

It is suitable for minor issues or when emotions are running high.

How does it solve our conflict?

Here, the **Project Manager decides to postpone the discussion** until after the application is released.

The conflict is temporarily avoided, but the bugs remain unfixed and the disagreement is still unresolved.

This may create even bigger problems later.

Now I invite **Presenter 4** to explain the **Accommodating** style.

Presenter 4 – Accommodating

Thank you.

The **Accommodating** style means putting another person's needs before your own.

It has **low assertiveness** and **high cooperativeness**.

This style is useful when maintaining relationships is more important than winning.

How does it solve our conflict?

In this case, the **Development Team agrees to delay the release** after listening to the Testing Team's concerns.

The software quality improves, and the relationship between both teams becomes stronger.

However, the project deadline is delayed because one team sacrifices its original objective.

Now I invite **Presenter 5** to explain the **Compromising** style.

Presenter 5 – Compromising

Thank you.

The **Compromising** style is about finding a middle ground where both parties give up something.

It represents a balance between assertiveness and cooperativeness.

It is useful when time is limited and a practical solution is needed.

How does it solve our conflict?

In this situation, the **Development Team fixes only the critical bugs**, while the **Testing Team agrees that minor bugs can be resolved in a future update**.

Both teams achieve a workable solution.

The product is released with acceptable quality, but neither team gets exactly what they wanted.

Now I invite **Presenter 6** to explain the **Collaborating** style.

Presenter 6 – Collaborating

Thank you.

The **Collaborating** style focuses on finding a solution that satisfies everyone.

It has **high assertiveness** and **high cooperativeness**, making it a true win-win approach.

It works best when long-term relationships and quality are important.

How does it solve our conflict?

The **Development Team and Testing Team work together** to identify and prioritize the critical bugs.

Developers immediately fix the issues, testers verify the fixes, and both teams communicate openly with the client to agree on a revised release schedule.

The client receives a reliable application, software quality improves, and both teams achieve their objectives.

Although this approach takes more time and effort, it provides the best long-term outcome.

I now hand it back to **Presenter 1** for the conclusion.

Presenter 1 – Conclusion

Thank you everyone.

As we've seen, the same workplace conflict can be handled in five different ways.

Each style has its own strengths and limitations, and no single approach is suitable for every situation.

The key lesson from the Thomas-Kilmann Model is that successful professionals choose the conflict management style based on the situation rather than reacting the same way every time.

Thank you.

We would now be happy to answer any questions.